

*Text*

**An intriguing book, *World paychecks: who makes what, where and why, makes some interesting international comparisons.*** In Japan, for example, teachers earn far less than factory workers, but in Denmark they are near the top of the wages scale. A New York rubbish collector makes three times as much as an Indian army general. A German bus driver gets double the pay packet of a British bus driver. In China some university teachers earn as much as government ministers, but Chinese newspaper and television journalists are the most poorly paid ones in the world. And so on.

In part, says the writer, this is because of the law of supply and demand. New York rubbish collectors are well paid because it is hard to find enough people who want to do the job, and in India generals do badly because everyone (well, almost everyone) wants to be a general. But other facts — whether having a certain job makes you famous, for example — also make a difference.

It may interest you to know that the President of the United States earns three times what the Prime Minister of Britain does, but that the Prime Ministers of India and China get only about £40 a week. I leave you to draw your own conclusions. One of the other interesting bits of information in the book is that Britain pays its civil servants (the people who are paid to help the government run things like the tax system and the post office) more than America and most of Europe. Don't ask me who decides these things; no one asked for my opinion.

*From an article by William Davis in Punch*

**A- READING COMPREHENSION**

**(6 points)**

**I) Choose the best answer : *The text mainly talks about* :**

**(1pt) a)**

- the importance of being a university teacher in China.
- b) - the impact of fame on the salaries of world leaders.
- c) - disparities in global wages and the factors that influence them.
- d) - a comparison between the British and American tax systems.

**2) Re-order the following ideas as they appear in the text**

**(1pt) a)**

- Specific salary comparisons between leaders of different nations.
- b) - The role of supply and demand in determining how much people are paid.
- c) - Examples of surprising wage differences between professions and countries.
- d) - Observations regarding the high pay of civil servants in Britain.

1- \_\_\_\_\_ 2 - \_\_\_\_\_ 3 - \_\_\_\_\_ 4 \_\_\_\_\_

**II) - Say if these sentences are true or false. Justify your answer by quoting from the text.**

**(1pt) 1)**

- In Japan, teachers are among the highest-paid professionals in the country.
- 2) - New York rubbish collectors earn high salaries because there are lack of people who want to do the work.

**III) Vocabulary**

**(1 pt)**

- 1) Find the synonym of "**salaries**" in the text:
- 2) Find the opposite of "**unknown**" in the text

**IV) – Answer these questions**

- 1- If a British bus driver earns £500 a month, how much does a German bus driver earn according to the text? **(1pt)**
- 2- In your opinion, is it fair that a rubbish collector in one country earns more than an army general in another? Why or why not? **(1pt)**

**B – GRAMMAR FOR COMMUNICATION**

**( 4 points)**

**I. Complete with a suitable relative pronoun :**

**(0,5 x 2= 1pt)**

- 1. My brother is the person \_\_\_\_\_ always helps me with my homework.
- 2. This is the new school \_\_\_\_\_ was built near the park.

**II. Choose the best item to complete each sentence:****(0.5 x 2= 1pt)**

- She got her hair \_\_\_\_\_ last week.  
a. to cut      b. cuts      c. cut      d. cutting
- The students were all \_\_\_\_\_ after the exam.  
a. exhausted      b. exhausting      c. exhaustion      d. exhaustive

**III. Reformulate the following sentences using the given prompts****(0,5 x 4= 2pts)****a) Even if I help my mother to prepare the dish, she never appreciate me.**

→ In spite of .....

**b) If will not go there, you will not understand**

→ Unless .....

**c) She told me : “ I have got my baccalaureate”**→ **She told me**.....**d) I didn't tell him the truth. I'm afraid he can't trust me.**→ **I wish** .....**C. INDIRECT ORAL TEST****( 5 points)****I – Rewrite the following expressions in a more formal way (1pt)**

A: Sorry for not coming on time.

B : It's O.K.

**II – Match the sentences in column A with those in B (0,5ptx2=1pt)**

| A                                                     | B                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Could you lend me Ar 10 000\$? I need it urgently. | a Complaining b-<br>Advising c-<br>Thanking d-<br>Requesting e-<br>regretting |
| 2. I wish I had revised my lessons.                   |                                                                               |
| 3. Why don't you see a Doctor?                        |                                                                               |
| 4. I'm afraid your soup is too salty.                 |                                                                               |

**III– Complete the following conversation (3 pts)****Tom** : \_\_\_\_\_ (1) \_\_\_\_\_ Alan ?**Allan** : My brother John doesn't stop teasing me. \_\_\_\_\_ (2) \_\_\_\_\_ ? (asking advice) **Tom**

: If I were you Allan, I'd tell that problem to your parents.

**Allan** : Thank you so much, Tom.**Tom** : \_\_\_\_\_ (3) \_\_\_\_\_. \_\_\_\_\_ (4) \_\_\_\_\_ next weekend Allan ? (asking for a weekend plan)**Allan** : I have nothing definite planned yet. Why are you asking ?**Tom** : You see, I'm having a birthday party on Saturday afternoon. \_\_\_\_\_ (5) \_\_\_\_\_ ? (inviting)**Allan** : \_\_\_\_\_ (6) \_\_\_\_\_. (accepting the invitation)**D – WRITING (5 points)**

“Nowadays, we do not need any qualification to get a good Job”. Do you agree or disagree? (in about 100-120 words)